

SARAH SPARKS

Customer Success Operations | Client Retention | CRM | Relationship Management

ssparks1822@outlook.com | 256-400-6107 | linkedin.com/in/ssparks1822 | sarah-sparks-ops-hub.lovable.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Client-facing operations professional with experience managing the full customer lifecycle in a high-stakes, emotionally complex service environment. Skilled in needs discovery, financial consultation, complaint resolution, CRM record management, and proactive follow-up. Consistently converts difficult conversations, including unexpected costs of \$2,000-\$15,000, into completed arrangements through empathy, transparency, and clear communication. Brings a psychology-informed approach to client engagement and the documentation discipline to back every interaction with accurate records. Actively developing Salesforce and analytics skills to grow into technology-sector customer success roles.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Customer lifecycle management Relationship building and retention Needs discovery and consultation Empathy-driven communication	Complaint resolution and recovery CRM administration, including HubSpot Proactive client follow-up Documentation and case management	Cross-functional coordination Financial consultation Process documentation AI-assisted productivity
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TECHNICAL SKILLS

CRM & Ops HubSpot: Pipeline, BOB, Tasks, Meetings, Outlook integration; PlotBox; Salesforce in progress; Microsoft Excel; Google Sheets.	Productivity Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, Adobe PDF, DocuSign, DocScan, Microsoft Teams.	AI & Design ChatGPT for client communication and workflow support; Canva.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Family Service Counselor | Client Success & Operations

Everstory Partners / Crestwood Funeral Home | Alabama | September 2025-Present

- Serve as the primary relationship owner for families navigating pre-need and at-need arrangements from initial consultation through contract execution and post-sale follow-up.
- Navigate difficult financial disclosures, including unexpected out-of-pocket costs ranging from \$2,000 to \$15,000, with empathy and transparency.
- Resolved a dual-monument billing conflict by structuring a vault upgrade that preserved company revenue, avoided a refund, and left the client satisfied.
- Identified data quality issues within customer records and collaborated across departments to ensure accurate documentation, timely follow-up, and CRM record integrity.
- Maintain 1,000+ contact records in HubSpot, logging client touchpoints, maintaining pipeline hygiene, and ensuring every interaction is documented and followed up.
- Log and track client complaint work orders, coordinating resolution across internal teams and external vendors through successful service recovery.
- Consistently meet a \$32K individual monthly sales quota, contributing to a team location quota exceeding \$100K monthly.
- Trained colleagues on HubSpot pipeline management and difficult client communication approaches.

Removal Technician

Stateline Mortuary Transportation | Regional Alabama | May 2025-September 2025

- Built an Excel-based transport tracking system from scratch after identifying no existing method to log calls, mileage, or payment across the team.
- Used self-maintained records to identify a compensation discrepancy, then compiled documentation and escalated directly to the CEO with evidence.
- Maintained chain-of-custody records and legal documentation in compliance with Alabama law across time-sensitive, emotionally demanding operations.

Owner & Operator

Purple Paw Spa | Independent | 2019-2025

- Operated an independent grooming business for six years, managing client scheduling, service records, supply ordering, and appointment communications.
- Used Excel as a client tracking system to organize service histories, repeat appointments, and customer follow-up.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts | General Studies | Southern New Hampshire University | 2025

Concentration: Psychology | Minor: Creative Writing

CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

Foundations: Data, Data, Everywhere | Google | May 2026
Ask Questions to Make Data-Driven Decisions | Google | Jun 2026
Accelerate Your Job Search with AI | Google | Jun 2026

Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate | In Progress, 2026
Project Management Team Leadership | Canvas / Badgr | Aug 2023
PM Primer: Conflict Resolution | Canvas / Badgr | Aug 2023
Effectively Managing Project Stakeholders | Canvas / Badgr | Aug 2023
Emotional Intelligence for Project Managers | Canvas / Badgr | Aug 2023